

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp

WEDNESDAY, DECEMBER 10, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVI NO. 137

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 47560.29 ▼ 179.03 0.38%

NASDAQ 23576.49 ▲ 0.1%

STOXX 600 577.77 ▼ 0.1%

10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 4/32, yield 4.185%

OIL \$58.25 ▼ \$0.63

GOLD \$4,206.70 ▲ \$19.50

EURO \$1.1626

YEN 156.89

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **The artificial-intelligence** chips that Nvidia is allowed to ship to China will undergo a special security review in the U.S. before they are exported, administration officials, said. **A1, A6**

◆ **Charlie Kirk's** posthumously published book "Stop, in the Name of God: Why Honoring the Sabbath Will Transform Your Life" sold out within hours on Amazon and was moving briskly at other outlets. **B3**

◆ **BMW made Milan** Nedeljković its next management board chairman, a role akin to CEO elsewhere, which he will assume after the company's annual meeting in May. **B1**

◆ **A sharp drop in** JPMorgan Chase shares helped depress the Dow by 0.4%, while the S&P 500 fell less than 0.1% and the Nasdaq rose 0.1%. **B12**

◆ **Silver hit a record**, powered by confidence that the Fed will cut interest rates this week and fears of a global supply squeeze. **B12**

◆ **National Economic Council** director Kevin Hassett said he wouldn't bow to political pressure to decide whether to cut interest rates if he becomes the next Fed chairman. **A2**

◆ **CBS News hired** Matt Gutman, a longtime ABC News journalist, as its chief correspondent, giving him a January start date and a Los Angeles base. **B1**

◆ **Exxon Mobil expects** higher earnings and cash flow through the end of the decade, driven partly by a more profitable business mix. **B2**

◆ **Campbell's said** tariff-related price increases weighed on its soup business as sales and profit fell in the latest quarter. **B3**

World-Wide

◆ **Trump dialed up** pressure on Ukraine to swiftly accept a U.S.-designed peace plan, hardening his position toward Kyiv and its European backers, who insist U.S. security guarantees are vital to any deal. **A7**

◆ **Trump touted** the economy in a campaign-rally-style speech in Pennsylvania and sought to blame Democrats on the affordability issue. **A4**

◆ **Senate Majority Leader** Thune said he would hold a vote later this week on a GOP measure aimed at controlling healthcare costs. **A4**

◆ **Miami elected** a Democrat as mayor for the first time in about three decades, as Eileen Higgins won decisively over a Trump-backed candidate. **A4**

◆ **Russian and Chinese** bombers flew near Japan and South Korea in a joint patrol that Tokyo described as a show of force. **A7**

◆ **Honduras's attorney general** urged international authorities to arrest a former president on corruption charges days after Trump pardoned him. **A7**

◆ **The family of a** Black teen fatally shot by a San Diego police officer will receive \$30 million after the City Council approved the payment. **A6**

◆ **A suspect was in custody** after one person was killed and one injured in a shooting at Kentucky State University. **A6**

◆ **A judge granted** the Justice Department's request to publicly release grand jury transcripts and other material from Ghislaine Maxwell's sex-trafficking case. **A6**

◆ **Died: Raul Malo**, 60, the Mavericks frontman. **A6**

CONTENTS Opinion..... A13-15
Arts in Review..... A12
Business & Finance B2-37
Crossword..... A11
From Page One..... A9
Hear on Street..... B13
Markets..... B12-13
Personal Journal A10-11
Property Report..... B6
Sports..... A16
Technology & Media B4
U.S. News..... A2-4,6
World News..... A7-8



© 2025 Dow Jones & Company, Inc.
All Rights Reserved

Civilians Flee Renewed Thai, Cambodian Fighting



EXODUS: A line of vehicles Tuesday in Oddar Meanchey province, Cambodia, streams away from fighting along the disputed border with Thailand. Tens of thousands fled on both sides after a skirmish Sunday derailed a cease-fire in effect since July. **A9**

Trump's Shift on Nvidia Chips Bolsters China's AI Ambitions

President lifted ban on sales soon after Justice Department filed smuggling case

By Stu Woo

SINGAPORE—With one unorthodox deal, President Trump instantly reshaped the U.S.-China technological Cold War. The fear among his critics: He just helped Beijing catch up.

By letting Nvidia sell its H200 artificial-intelligence

chips to China, he gave the U.S. company the giant market it demanded. But he also handed China's AI industry what it couldn't build itself: the high-end semiconductors needed to rival the U.S.

Until Monday, a political debate swirled around these chips. National-security hawks argued they had to be withheld to stifle China's development of military weaponry and, perhaps one day, advanced AI systems that outfox humans.

On the other side was Nvidia with this counterargu-

ment: Chinese cash fuels American innovation.

Trump effectively settled the argument by siding with the world's most valuable company.

"We will protect National Security, create American Jobs, and keep America's lead in AI," he wrote on social media.

While the mechanics of the deal remain fuzzy—Trump said Washington would collect 25% of Nvidia's China sales without explaining how—the winners are clear.

First is Nvidia, the undis-

puted AI chip leader, which estimated it could ship up to \$5 billion in orders to China every quarter without geopolitical constraints.

The second is China itself. Its domestic chip makers make inferior products—and not enough of them.

One famous Chinese startup, DeepSeek, has already shown it can do surprising things with relatively few Nvidia chips.

Please turn to page A6

◆ **AI chips for China to get a security check..... A6**

Fed Eyes Rate Cut, Higher Bar for Next Move

Powell aims to stitch together consensus over growing divisions

By Nick Timiraos

When Federal Reserve officials gathered on Tuesday for their final two-day rate-setting meeting of the year, as much as half the room might have been against a cut.

But the final call rests with Chair Jerome Powell, who appears poised to secure one despite the unusual opposition.

The focus this week will be whether Powell can stitch together enough consensus to minimize dissents. That would likely happen by cutting interest rates a quarter point to a range of 3.5% to 3.75% and then signaling a higher bar for further easing, through changes to the postmeeting statement. This cut-and-cap approach would echo how Powell concluded a sequence of three rate cuts in 2019 that also divided the committee.

Powell led his colleagues to cut in September and October after judging that the labor market looked shakier and the tariff-driven inflation surge that many feared hadn't materialized. That assessment would also underpin a decision to cut this week.

Yet resistance to cuts has built among a group of policymakers who already saw a weak case for cutting at the past two meetings. These officials are uneasy because inflation has stopped declining toward the Fed's 2% target. They worry interest rates might not

Please turn to page A2

OpenAI Aims to Correct Course and Fend Off Google

CEO Altman is now prioritizing chatbot ChatGPT in a company that has been divided over its strategic goals

When OpenAI CEO Sam Altman made the dramatic call for a "code red" last week to beat back a rising threat from Google, he put a notable priority at the top of his list of fixes.

By Sam Schechner, Berber Jin and Keach Hagey

The world's most valuable startup should pause its side projects like its Sora video generator for eight weeks and focus on improving ChatGPT, its popular chatbot that

kicked off the AI boom.

In so doing, Altman was making a major strategic course correction and taking sides in a broader philosophical divide inside the company—between its pursuit of popularity among everyday consumers and its quest for research greatness.

OpenAI was founded to pursue artificial general intelligence, broadly defined as being able to outthink humans at almost all tasks. But for the company to survive, Altman was

Please turn to page A9

INSIDE



SPORTS

A grandfather is suiting up at quarterback for the Indianapolis Colts. **A16**



U.S. NEWS

Texas Tech charts out a forceful curb on gender and race curriculum. **A3**

Inside Paramount's Pursuit of Warner

Paramount Chief Executive David Ellison knew his latest bid for Warner Bros. Discovery was in trouble when the company's CEO, David Zaslav, started ghosting him.

By Joe Flint, Brian Schwartz and Natalie Andrews

Paramount had spent the morning of Dec. 4 finalizing its sixth bid to acquire all of Warner: an all-cash \$77.9 billion offer. But Paramount was worried that Warner had already settled on their preferred dance partner: Netflix.

"Just tried calling you about new bid we have submitted," Ellison texted Zaslav. "I heard you on all your concerns and believe we have addressed them in our new proposal. Please give me a call back when you can to discuss in detail."

He didn't hear back. Sensing trouble, Ellison followed up, saying Paramount

had offered a package that covered all the issues Warner had raised, including the need for "strong cash value" and "speed to close."

"It would be the honor of a lifetime to be your partner and to be the owner of these iconic assets," he texted, according to a regulatory filing.

On Friday, Ellison's concerns were realized. Warner and Netflix announced a deal for the streaming giant to acquire the iconic Warner and HBO properties for \$72 billion, a proposed merger that could radically reshape entertainment.

Ellison's father, billionaire Oracle co-founder Larry Ellison, a Trump ally, called the president after the Netflix deal was announced and told him the transaction would hurt competition, according to a White House official and a person familiar with the matter.

An Oracle spokeswoman

Please turn to page A4

Daters Confront a Vibe Killer: The 'Swag Gap'

Clash of styles can doom a courtship; 'It felt like a smack in the face'

By NATASHA DANGOOR

Dillon Escourse had meticulously curated his statement look for a recent date at a bar in Houston. He arrived wearing a thrifted orange zip-up hoodie, a camouflage cropped tee and boot-cut jeans—an aesthetic designed to complement the venue's Latin and jazz scene.

His date, whom he had been seeing for a couple of months, showed up in black Lululemon leggings, an oversize gray sweatshirt and dirty Nike Air Forces. The "casual chic" look didn't go over well with Escourse, who said the outfit didn't match the vibe of the bar and took her choice of clothing as a personal slight. "You want to look good for the person you're with, not throw on pajama pants and Crocs," said Escourse, a 20-

year-old student at the University of Houston. "It felt like a smack in the face."

Escourse is wrestling with a dating obstacle that members of his generation call the "swag gap." The term refers to a fundamental difference in the way two people carry and present themselves that goes beyond the beauty-meets-brain dynamic long depicted in popular culture. It's more of an "I'm dressed for a cocktail hour and my partner is dressed for a remote workday" situation. And if the cautionary tales on social media are any indication, it's a misalignment that should serve as a flashing signal to get out before someone gets hurt.

Escourse heeded the warnings and ended the nascent relationship shortly after the date. He plans to implement a more rigorous vetting process

Please turn to page A11